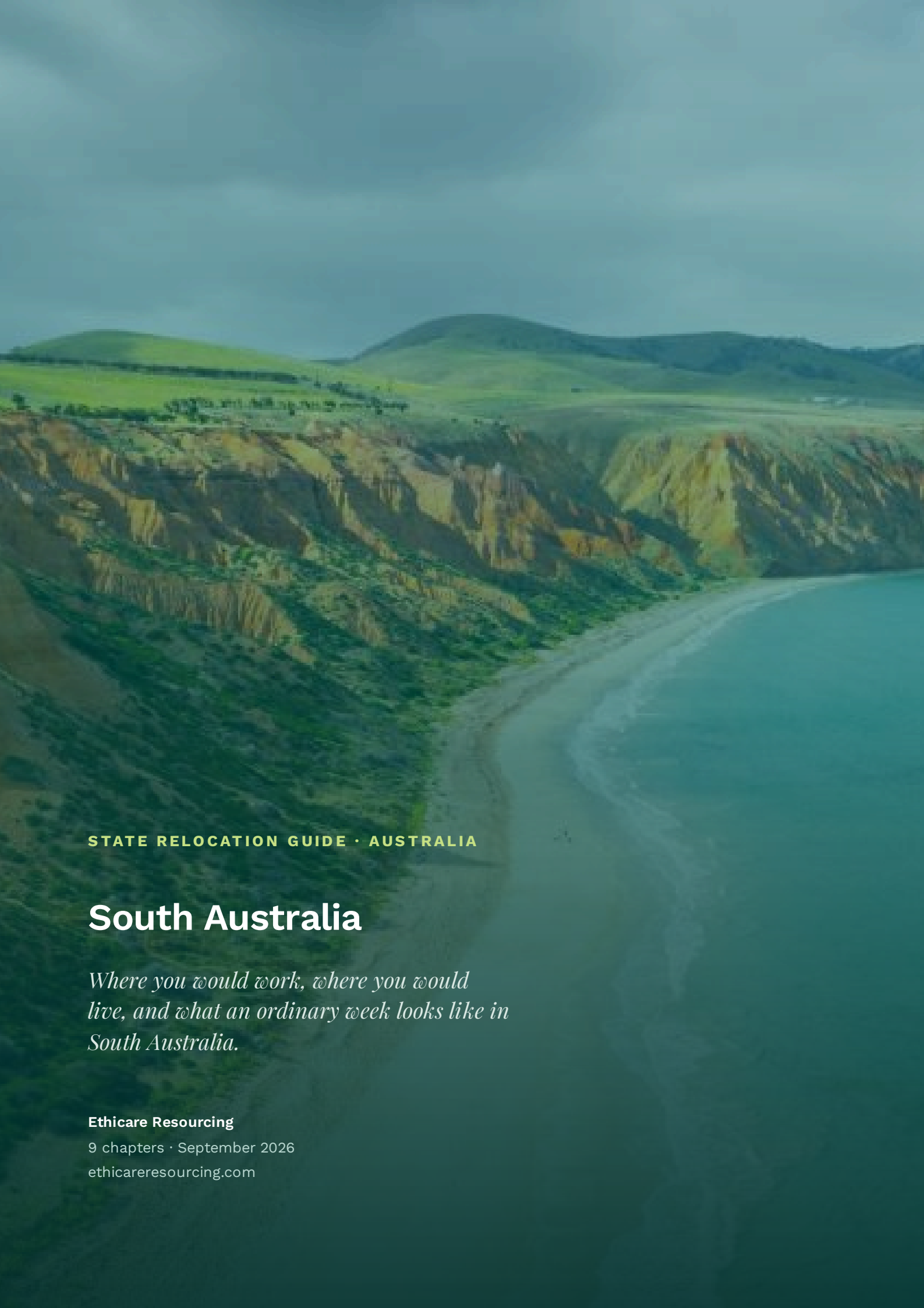




STATE RELOCATION GUIDE · AUSTRALIA

South Australia

Where you would work, where you would live, and what an ordinary week looks like in South Australia.

Ethicare Resourcing

9 chapters · September 2026

ethicareresourcing.com

What's inside

01 Welcome to South Australia

02 Why South Australia

03 South Australia at a glance

04 Healthcare in South Australia

05 Where clinicians live

06 Getting around

07 Cost of living

08 Food, wine & the everyday

09 Wine country, coast & ranges

This guide is free, and so is everything in it. Every chapter here is also on the website, where it is kept up to date — so if you are reading this some months after downloading it, check the site for anything that looks time-sensitive. Fees, tax rates and immigration settings change without much notice.

We don't print these. A PDF costs nothing to send and nothing to ship, which felt like the right answer for a company that spends its days moving people around the world.

Welcome to South Australia

South Australia Guide · Chapter 1 of 9

South Australia is the state where the arithmetic works: a genuine major-hospital career in the most affordable mainland capital, with the hills twenty minutes from the wards, the sea forty, and world-famous wine country under an hour. It asks one thing in return — that you like your city elegant and unhurried rather than enormous.

An easy, elegant capital — and a state beyond it

Adelaide holds about 1.4 million people — three-quarters of the state — on a grid Colonel Light laid out in 1836, ringed completely by parklands. It is Australia's festival city: every March the Fringe, the Festival and WOMADelaide turn the whole centre into a stage, and for the rest of the year it runs on markets, laneway bars and cellar-door weekends. The health system is genuinely big for the city's size, with one of the newest hospital-and-research precincts in the southern hemisphere along its main boulevard.

Beyond the city the state changes register. The Adelaide Hills, the Barossa and the Clare Valley wrap the capital in vines and stone villages; the green South-East runs to the Victorian border around the state's largest regional city; the Riverland follows the Murray through fruit and wine country; and the gulf towns and the Eyre Peninsula face some of the wildest coast in the country, with the Flinders Ranges and the outback beyond.

The honest costs are a fierce, dry summer with real 40-degree runs, power bills among the dearest in the country, and a job market that is one city deep — most of the state's medicine happens in Adelaide, and the regional centres are genuinely regional. This guide prices all three plainly.

Who wrote this

We're a healthcare recruitment company, so we have an interest — but this guide isn't a pitch. There's nothing in it asking you to register, no form, and no visa advice.

South Australia is where the money and the life line up best of the mainland states, and also where "will the job market fit me?" needs the most honest answer. Where we think it's the wrong state for you, we say so.

The state, in nine numbers

~1.85M

People in the state – about the population of Perth, spread across an area four times the size of the UK.

~1.4M

In Greater Adelaide – roughly three in four South Australians live in or around the capital.

10

Local health networks – three metropolitan, six country, and a statewide women's and children's service.

~50%

Of Australia's wine is made here – the Barossa, Clare, McLaren Vale and the Hills all sit within about an hour of the city.

~30 km

Of white-sand metropolitan beach, from North Haven down to Sellicks – with a tram to the middle of it.

20 min

From the city to the Adelaide Hills. The sea is about forty. This is the "20-minute city" people talk about.

UTC+9½

The half-hour time zone – thirty minutes behind Sydney and Melbourne, with daylight saving in summer.

1836

Founded as a planned free settlement – no convicts, a fact locals will mention – and a haven for religious dissenters.

10c

Per can and bottle – the container deposit has run since 1977, and returning them is a genuine local habit.

Six things you only learn once you're here

The half-hour clock is real

SA runs thirty minutes behind the east coast. National meetings land at odd times, football starts at half past, and every newcomer misses one call in their first month.

Summer is dry and serious

Heatwaves run past 40° for days, then break with a cool change off the Southern Ocean you can feel arrive. A good split system is infrastructure, not comfort.

Power bills bite

SA electricity is among the dearest in the country. An efficient home and a carefully chosen energy plan matter more here than almost anywhere in Australia.

Mad March is a season

The Fringe – the biggest arts festival in the southern hemisphere – the Festival, WOMADelaide and the motorsport all land at once. Book nothing else for March.

It's a two-degrees city

"Which school did you go to?" is a genuine Adelaide icebreaker. Everyone seems to know everyone – which makes reputations, good and bad, travel fast.

The deli is an institution

The corner deli – part milk bar, part grocer – survives here as it does nowhere else, along with Foodland, the fiercely local supermarket.

A note on Country

Adelaide stands on Kaurna Country – Tarntanya, the place of the red kangaroo – and the state spans many nations: Peramangk in the Hills, Ngadjuri in the mid-north, Boandik in the South-East, Barngarla on the upper gulf, Erawirung along the river. You'll see dual naming used widely and warmly.

Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings, and health services work in partnership with Aboriginal community-controlled organisations. Take the cultural induction seriously – in the far north it is central to the job.

How to read this guide

Nine chapters, all of them about South Australia specifically. Anything true of Australia generally – Medicare, visas, Ahpra registration, tax, superannuation, schools – lives once in [Moving to Australia](#) rather than being repeated here.

If you read nothing else, read [Why South Australia](#) for the full case – and what we'd ask you to weigh, and [Where clinicians live](#), because Adelaide's villages and the country posts are decisions of a completely different kind.

Why South Australia

South Australia Guide · Chapter 2 of 9

Every state has a brochure. This chapter is the conversation we'd have instead: what South Australia actually gives a working clinician, what a week here plausibly looks like, and who we'd honestly point somewhere else.

The arithmetic

Start with the sum most people never quite write down. Adelaide is the most affordable mainland capital: a three-bedroom family house rents for hundreds of dollars a week less than its Sydney equivalent, and buying one is a realistic mid-career plan rather than a fantasy. There are no toll roads anywhere in the state, commutes are among the shortest of any Australian capital, and the whole of South Australia is classed as regional for skilled migration — which can mean extra visa points and pathways the east-coast capitals can't offer.

Against that, salaries sit broadly in the national range for public health — the enterprise agreements differ state by state, and we'll always walk you through the current ones rather than quote figures here. The point isn't that you earn dramatically more in SA. It's that the same career buys noticeably more life.

\$0

Toll roads in the state

<1 hr

To the Barossa, the Vale or the Hills

100%

Of SA counts as regional for migration

A typical week

A week here can plausibly hold all of this. A city-hospital shift that starts without a toll-road crawl, because most of Adelaide is twenty-odd minutes from most of the rest of it. A swim at Henley or Brighton before a late start — the sea sits at the end of the tram line. A Thursday-evening shop at the Central Market, where the produce is better and cheaper than any supermarket. Saturday lunch at a McLaren Vale cellar door, forty minutes south, and Sunday on the Heysen Trail in the Hills before the working week resets.

None of that is a holiday itinerary. It's the ordinary shape of a week when a city this liveable is also this small — and it is exactly what people mean when they say their salary “goes further” here. The distance between your roster and your life shrinks.

Sophie's insight

What I love most about South Australia is how much life it offers for the money. Having spent years in the NHS, I know how easily work can take over — and what stands out in Adelaide is how close everything is. The hills, the sea and the vines are all a short drive away, and people genuinely make time for them.

My advice: think about your commute, your community and what you'll do on your days off. Those things shape your happiness more than people expect.

Sophie Careem Founder & CEO, Ethicare Resourcing

When we'd suggest a bigger market

The market is one city deep

Most of the state's medicine happens in Adelaide. It carries fewer tertiary sites than Sydney, Melbourne or Brisbane, so a narrow sub-specialty may simply have more room on the east coast.

Summer is fierce

Dry heat, real 40-degree runs, and a long brown February. If you wilt in heat and can't love an early-morning life for two months a year, think hard.

It's a quiet city

Adelaide is elegant, not electric. If what recharges you is big-city churn — new restaurants weekly, a giant professional scene — Melbourne or Sydney will fit better.

The east coast is a flight away

Melbourne is eight hours' drive, Sydney fourteen. If your family network lands in the eastern capitals, every visit becomes a fare rather than a drive.

The regions are genuinely regional

The South-East, the Riverland and the gulf towns are hours from the capital, with the specialist and schooling limits that brings. Rewarding — but go in with open eyes.

Where we'd steer you instead

If you need a second tertiary city within driving distance, look at **Victoria** — Melbourne plus a ring of genuine regional centres.

If winter sun is the whole point, **Queensland** is the honest answer — SA winters are cool and green.

If you want scale and don't mind paying for it, **New South Wales** carries the country's biggest health system.

In our experience

South Australia suits clinicians who've stopped equating bigger with better — the market is one city deep, but that city gives back its evenings and weekends like nowhere else. If your sub-specialty fits, the life here is very hard to argue with.

South Australia at a glance

South Australia Guide · Chapter 3 of 9

Before the practical chapters, orientation. South Australia is the driest state on the driest inhabited continent, and it divides — for a newcomer's purposes — into three quite different places sharing one capital, one climate pattern and one eccentric clock.

The three South Australias

Adelaide and its ring

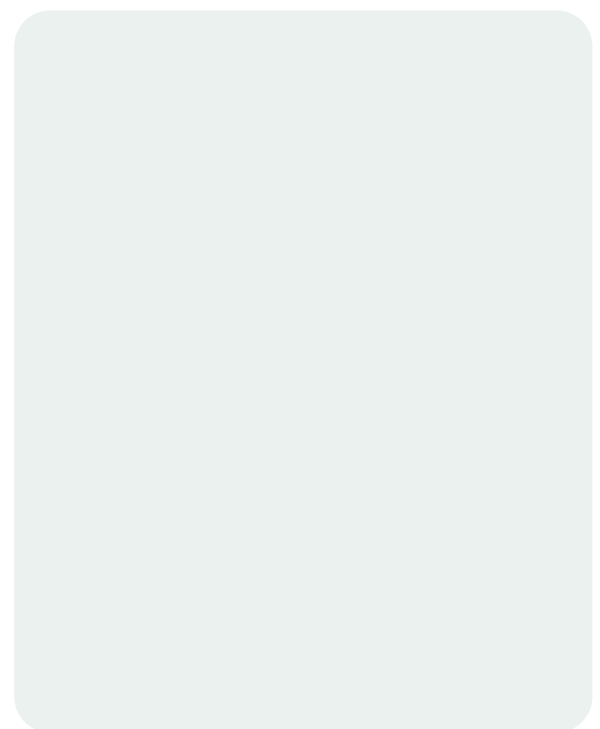
The capital, the Hills behind it, the Barossa and Clare to the north, McLaren Vale and the Fleurieu Peninsula to the south. Nine in ten of the state's health jobs sit inside this circle, and nearly everything in it is within an hour of everything else. If you take a city post, this ring is your whole life map — beaches, vines, hills and wards.

The green South-East

The Limestone Coast runs to the Victorian border — the coolest, wettest, greenest corner of the state, built on pine forests, vineyards and dairy country around the state's largest regional city with its famous volcanic Blue Lake. It looks and feels closer to rural Victoria than to the outback, and its referral hospital serves a wide catchment.

The gulfs and the outback

North and west of Adelaide the country opens out: the Yorke Peninsula's quiet farming coast, the industrial towns of the Upper Spencer Gulf betting big on steel and hydrogen, the Eyre Peninsula's seafood ports facing the Southern Ocean, and beyond them the Flinders Ranges and the arid far north, where health care runs on small teams, aviation and telehealth.



Where Adelaide sits, with the straight-line distance to Mount Gambier

A year in the weather

The climate is genuinely Mediterranean: hot, dry summers and mild, green winters, with the rain arriving May to September. Summer brings real heatwaves – runs of days past 40° most years – which end, theatrically, with a cool change rolling in off the Southern Ocean. The Hills sit several degrees cooler and greener; the South-East is the mildest corner; the far north is properly arid.

Summer

Dec – Feb

17–29°

Dry heat · 40° runs

Autumn

Mar – May

12–23°

Mad March · vintage

Winter

Jun – Aug

8–16°

Cool, green, wet

Spring

Sep – Nov

11–22°

Jacarandas · festivals

Two practical notes. Older housing stock often has thin insulation and patchy heating – make a good split system a rental-search criterion, for both ends of the year. And take the heat itself seriously: hydration, sun protection and a plan for very hot days matter, especially with children or older family members.

The half-hour clock

South Australia runs on Australian Central Standard Time – UTC+9½, thirty minutes behind Sydney and Melbourne – and, unlike Queensland, it does observe daylight saving, becoming UTC+10½ each summer. The practical effects are small but constant: national meetings land at five past the half-hour, broadcast times shift, and Perth sits ninety minutes behind you in winter. You adjust within a month; your phone adjusts instantly.

Getting in and out

Adelaide Airport is unusually close to the city – about fifteen minutes from the CBD, on the way to the beach. It flies direct to every Australian capital and to a handful of international hubs, so most of the world is one stop away; and regional services reach Port Lincoln, Whyalla, Mount Gambier and Kangaroo Island. Melbourne is a day's drive down the coast or up the highway; everywhere else east is realistically a flight.

Words you'll hear in week one

TarntanyaKaurna name for the Adelaide Plains – “place of the red kangaroo”; widely used in dual naming

Mad March The month the Fringe, Festival, WOMA Adelaide and the motorsport all happen at once
The cool change The southerly front that ends a heatwave — you can feel the temperature drop ten degrees in minutes
Stobie pole SA's concrete-and-steel power pole, invented here because termites eat wooden ones
Fritz The luncheon sausage every SA childhood runs on — ask for it at the deli, on white bread with sauce
Heaps good High praise, delivered flat. The state's unofficial motto
The Riverland The Murray River fruit-and-wine country in the state's east
Pie floater A meat pie upturned in pea soup — a heritage-listed Adelaide late-night institution

Healthcare in South Australia

South Australia Guide · Chapter 4 of 9



Registration is national; hiring is local. This chapter explains how South Australia organises its public system, where the work actually is, and what to ask before you sign — without naming employers, because our job is to be useful before it is to be promotional.

How the state system is organised

SA Health runs the public system through ten local health networks: three metropolitan networks covering the centre, north and south of Adelaide, six country networks covering the regions, and one statewide women's and children's service. Each network hires in its own right — so “a job in SA” is really a job in one network's geography, and moving between them later is a fresh application, not a transfer.

Alongside the public networks sit a substantial private and not-for-profit hospital sector concentrated in Adelaide, a state ambulance service, and Aboriginal community-controlled health organisations that are significant employers and partners, particularly in the country networks and the far north.

Three metro networks

Central, northern and southern Adelaide — each anchored by a major teaching hospital, with the city's western boulevard now holding one of the newest hospital-and-research precincts in the southern hemisphere.

Six country networks

The Limestone Coast, the river country, the Barossa-Hills-Fleurieu ring, the Yorke and mid-north, the Eyre and far north, and the Flinders and upper gulf — each with its own referral hospitals and community sites.

A statewide children's service

Paediatric and maternity specialist care runs as its own network, serving the whole state from the capital with outreach into the regions.

Where the work is

Tertiary and quaternary medicine concentrates in Adelaide, which for its size carries a genuinely deep hospital system — including the state's major trauma capacity and its teaching, research and specialist services. The city's north is the growth corridor, where demand has risen fastest; the south pairs a large

university-linked hospital campus with an expanding outer-suburban population.

In the country networks, referral hospitals in the South-East and on the gulfs anchor genuinely broad-scope roles: generalist skills are prized, waits for the niche are traded for breadth and responsibility, and posts frequently carry relocation support, accommodation help and retention incentives that a city advertisement won't show. The far north runs on small resident teams, visiting specialists, aviation and telehealth — demanding, distinctive work that suits experienced clinicians who want their scope wide.

One structural advantage worth repeating: the whole of South Australia — Adelaide included — is classed as regional for skilled migration, which can open extra visa pathways and points. The detail lives in [Visas & the move](#).

ONE REGISTER, TEN EMPLOYERS

10

LOCAL HEALTH NETWORKS, ONE NATIONAL REGISTER

Named below, and each hires in its own right — so a move between them later is a fresh application rather than a transfer. That makes your first choice the consequential one, and worth making deliberately rather than by whichever advertisement you saw first.

Your registration, by contrast, moves with you anywhere in Australia. The process, English evidence and assessment pathways live once in [Eligibility & registration](#).

“

Registration is national. Hiring is network by network. Plan for both.

The one-line version

What to ask at interview

Pay here follows state enterprise agreements that differ from the east coast's — we deliberately quote no figures in this guide, and will always walk you through the current agreement for your profession instead.

What you can pin down at interview:

Salary packaging — public-health roles can package part of your pay pre-tax; ask how much and how to start it on day one

The roster reality – shift patterns, penalties, on-call frequency and how rosters are actually built
Public, private or both – many SA careers mix the two; ask what rights of private practice exist
CPD – how much funded time and money, and whether interstate conference travel counts
Supervision and support – especially for internationally trained clinicians in your first year
Parking and commute at your shift times – easy by east-coast standards, still worth confirming
For country posts: the incentive package – relocation, housing, retention payments and leave for city travel

Professional indemnity – what the employer covers and what remains yours to hold

Two things to do early

Start registration as soon as SA is on your shortlist – paperwork, not ambition, is what moves start dates.

And once you land, arrange ambulance cover: it is not automatic in South Australia, and a state ambulance membership or insurance add-on is inexpensive insurance against a very expensive ride.

Where clinicians live

South Australia Guide · Chapter 5 of 9



Adelaide is small enough that this decision is forgiving – get it slightly wrong and you're still twenty minutes from work. But the choice between the city's villages, the Hills and a country post is a decision of a different kind, so here is the map as we'd draw it over coffee.

Adelaide's inner ring

North Adelaide, Prospect, Unley, Norwood, Goodwood: bluestone villas and cottages on tree-lined streets, cafés on the corner, the parklands between you and the wards. This is where many hospital staff start – walkable, characterful, close to everything – and where rents run highest, though “highest” here would read as ordinary in Sydney. Apartments in the CBD itself suit short first leases while you learn the city.

The coast by tram

Glenelg, and the beach suburbs running north through Brighton, Somerton, Henley and Grange, give Adelaide something rare among capitals: sand at the end of a tram line, with city hospitals a straightforward ride away. Sunsets over the gulf, esplanade coffee, jetty swims before a late shift. Summer weekends get busy and parking with them; that is the whole complaint.

The Hills and the wine valleys

Stirling, Aldgate and Crafers sit in genuine hill country – cooler, greener, autumn colour, a Sunday-morning fog – twenty to thirty minutes up the freeway from town. Further out, Mount Barker is one of the fastest-growing towns in the state and noticeably better value; the Barossa's towns (Tanunda, Nuriootpa, Angaston) and the Fleurieu's (Willunga, Victor Harbor) offer village life with vines, served by their own regional health sites and within reach of the city's. The trade: you will drive, and on summer fire-danger days you'll live by the warnings like everyone else.

The regional centres, honestly

The state's largest regional city sits in the green South-East, four and a half hours from Adelaide near the Victorian border – around thirty thousand people, a proper referral hospital, forests and famously blue crater lakes, and Melbourne nearer than Adelaide. The Riverland towns – Renmark, Berri, Loxton – hold

some of the most affordable housing in the state, two to three hours from the city along the Murray. On the gulfs, Whyalla and Port Augusta anchor a region betting big on steel and hydrogen, and Port Lincoln faces the Southern Ocean across seafood country, a seven-hour drive or fifty-minute flight from town.

These are real communities with real hospitals and the strongest incentives in the state – and they are genuinely far away, with fewer specialist and schooling options. The clinicians who thrive in them wanted breadth and belonging, not a smaller Adelaide. Say the hard thing early: if what you want is the city with a discount, choose the outer suburbs instead.

The honest comparison

~A\$560/wk
Indicative Adelaide house rent (3-bed median)
Less
Again in the regional centres – among Australia's cheapest housing
4 wks
Maximum bond, plus up to two weeks' rent in advance

If you want...	Consider	Because
The widest job market	Adelaide's inner ring	Every tertiary site within half an hour
Beach life on a roster	Glenelg to Grange	The tram and the coast road do the commute
Space and a garden	Mount Barker & the Hills	Value, schools, freeway access – bring a car
Village-and-vines life	Barossa & Fleurieu towns	Regional sites nearby, the city an hour away
A green regional city	The South-East	The state's biggest regional hub, mildest weather
Maximum affordability	The Riverland	River-country housing at country prices
Wide scope & wild coast	The gulfs & Eyre	Broad roles, strong incentives, real remoteness

Renting itself – applications, bonds, rights, the documents that win a tight market – works the same across Australia and lives once in [Living in Australia](#). The one SA-specific habit worth copying: arrive with your references, proof of income and offer letter as clean PDFs; a complete same-day application regularly beats a longer local history.

Before you sign a lease
Is the property inside the school zone you need? Zones run street by street here.
How long is the commute at your actual shift times – and is there parking at both ends?
Does the home have decent cooling and heating? Older stock often doesn't.
Would a short-term rental first be wiser? Most people re-choose their suburb once they know the city.

Getting around

South Australia Guide · Chapter 6 of 9



Adelaide's transport story is mostly the absence of pain: no toll roads anywhere in the state, some of the shortest commutes of any Australian capital, and an airport fifteen minutes from the office. Beyond the metro map, the state is big and the car comes back.

The city, without a car

metroCARD

Trains, trams and buses run on one tap-on card — or just a contactless bank card. Simple, and cheap by east-coast standards.

The tram

One line, but the right one: free through the city centre, then out to the beach at Glenelg. It makes the coast a commute, not an outing.

Trains

Suburban lines reach the coast, the northern growth corridor and the south. Small network, honest timetable.

The O-Bahn

Adelaide's oddity: buses on a guided concrete track to the north-east — one of the fastest suburban runs in the country.

Living car-free is realistic along the tram corridor, in the inner ring and near a train line. It stops being realistic in the Hills, the wine valleys and anywhere regional — plan on a car for those from day one.

Driving here

Australians drive on the left, and Adelaide is the easiest capital to learn in: a flat grid, ring routes, no tolls, and rush hours that would make a Sydneysider laugh. You can usually drive on a valid overseas licence for a period after arriving, then transfer to a South Australian licence once you're resident — the rules, and buying a car, live in [Living in Australia](#).

Two local notes. The power poles are concrete-and-steel stobie poles — unforgiving, which is partly why SA drivers treat them with respect. And country driving is its own skill: long distances, wildlife at dawn and dusk, and fuel stops you plan rather than assume, especially on the Eyre Peninsula and north of the gulfs.

Reaching the regions

From Adelaide to...	By road	Otherwise
The Barossa	~1 hr	Day-tour territory
Clare Valley	~2 hrs	—
The Riverland	2.5–3 hrs	—
Whyalla & the upper gulf	~4 hrs	Short regional flight
The South-East	~4.5 hrs	Regional flight
Port Lincoln	~7 hrs	50-minute flight
Kangaroo Island	~2 hrs + ferry	35-minute flight
Melbourne	~8 hrs	Hourly flights

Adelaide Airport flies direct to every capital and a handful of international hubs; regional services cover the flying-distance towns above. If you take a country post, ask about travel allowances in the package — regular trips to the city are a real cost and a normal ask.

The takeaway

In Adelaide, transport will be the least of your problems — pick a home near your work or a tram/train line and the city does the rest. Everywhere else in the state, budget for a reliable car before you budget for anything else.

Cost of living

South Australia Guide · Chapter 7 of 9



The honest picture is a happy one, so let's audit it anyway. Adelaide is the most affordable mainland capital, the regions cost less again — and there are three costs the sunshine hides that deserve to be weighed before you commit.

Why there are no prices on this page

We used to print a weekly rent and a monthly budget table here. We have taken them out. A figure that was true when a page was written is misleading a year later, and a candidate who plans a move around a stale number is worse off than one who plans around none.

What does not go stale is the relationship between places — which suburb, ring or region you choose — and the judgement about which costs catch people out. That is what the rest of this chapter is for. For today's actual numbers use the calculators at the foot of the page, and use them to compare it against the city you are leaving. That is the only comparison that decides anything.

The headline

What doesn't change is the relationship: like-for-like housing runs hundreds of dollars a week below Sydney and well below Melbourne, and it is housing that decides whether a salary feels big.

What everyday life costs

THE COSTS THE SUNSHINE HIDES

Adelaide is the most affordable mainland capital and the regions cost less again. These three lines are the ones worth pricing before you commit – none of them shows up in a rent comparison.

Power

SA electricity is among the dearest in the country, and summer cooling is non-negotiable. An efficient home and a deliberately chosen energy plan are worth real money a year – compare retailers before you sign anything.

The car you'll probably own

Inner-ring and tram-corridor life can be car-free; most SA lives aren't. Price a reliable used car, registration and insurance into your arrival budget rather than discovering it in month two.

Flights east

If your people are in Sydney, Melbourne or overseas via the east, visits are fares, not drives. Two or three trips a year is the realistic line most families settle on – budget it.

Where the money comes back

The rent gap against the eastern capitals is the big one – for many households it covers the whole grocery bill. The small ones accumulate: no tolls, cheap parking by capital standards, commutes short enough to save childcare hours, the Central Market beating supermarket prices on produce, and the 10-cent container deposit quietly funding the coffee habit.

On the income side, public-health and not-for-profit roles here can salary-package part of your pay before tax – in a lower-cost city the effect on real quality of life is significant, and many international staff don't set it up until far too late. How packaging, tax and superannuation work is national and lives in [Pay & conditions](#); the SA habit to copy is simply asking payroll about it on day one.

The bottom line

Plan the bridge, not just the destination: temporary accommodation, a bond of up to four weeks' rent plus up to two weeks in advance, a first car, and setting up a home. In Adelaide that bridge costs far less than in the eastern capitals – but the people who arrive calm are the ones who priced it anyway.

Get today's numbers, and compare them to home

These are live and updated continuously, which is why we send you to them rather than competing with them. Put the city you are leaving in the other box.

Numbeo cost-of-living calculator (<https://www.numbeo.com/cost-of-living/>) — the most complete comparison tool, and the one most clinicians already use. Crowd-sourced, so read it as a ballpark rather than a quote.

Expatistan (<https://www.expatistan.com/cost-of-living>) — the same idea with a cleaner side-by-side. Worth running as a sanity check when Numbeo looks off.

Australian Bureau of Statistics (<https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/economy/price-indexes-and-inflation>) — official, slower, and the one to trust on the direction of travel rather than any single price.

If what you find contradicts the judgement on this page, tell us. We would rather correct the page than defend it.

Food, wine & the everyday

South Australia Guide · Chapter 8 of 9

South Australia's everyday food culture runs through one building: the Central Market, trading since 1869 in the middle of the city grid. Around it sit the fiercely local supermarket, the surviving corner deli, and — because this is SA — the assumption that decent wine is a grocery, not a luxury.

The Market and the weekly shop

The Adelaide Central Market is one of the best fresh-food markets in the country — seventy-odd stalls of produce, cheese, seafood, bread and world cuisines under one roof, cheaper and better than the supermarkets for most of what matters. Hospital staff treat Thursday evening or early Saturday as the serious shopping windows; go late Saturday afternoon for the closing-time bargains.

For the rest: Woolworths and Coles run full-range stores everywhere, ALDI is the cheapest weekly shop, and the local pride is real — Drakes and Foodland are South Australian institutions, and in the regional towns the independent grocer still anchors the main street. The corner deli — part milk bar, part grocer, part sandwich counter — survives in Adelaide as it does nowhere else in the country.

Bring your bags

SA was the first state to ban lightweight plastic bags, and the checkout assumes you came prepared.

Save your bottles

The 10-cent container deposit has run since 1977. A crate in the boot and a monthly depot run is a genuine local rhythm.

Farmers' markets

Willunga on Saturday morning is the flagship; the Hills, Barossa and regional towns all keep their own.

The fritz order

At the deli counter, fritz and sauce on white bread is the childhood taste of the state. Order it once, for citizenship.

Flavours of home

For its size, Adelaide feeds its communities well. The western suburbs carry the Italian and Greek heritage – delis, continental grocers, the long Sunday lunch; the north and north-east are the centre of gravity for Asian, African and Middle-Eastern groceries; halal butchers are easy to find across the northern suburbs; and kosher supplies, while more limited than Sydney or Melbourne, are available through the long-established community in the east. The Market fills most gaps in one visit.

In the regional centres the range narrows honestly – a good independent grocer, a local butcher, sometimes a specialist aisle. Families in the Riverland, the South-East and on the gulfs tend to stock up on city trips or order online, and it works better than newcomers expect.

Eating and drinking out

Adelaide eats above its weight. The laneway small-bar scene – Peel Street, Leigh Street and their neighbours – arrived a decade ago and stayed; the pub is still the default meeting place; and the cellar doors of McLaren Vale, the Hills and the Barossa double as the state's best long lunches, forty minutes to an hour from town. Coffee is taken seriously without Melbourne's theology about it.

The heritage list is cheerfully odd: the pie floater – a meat pie upturned in pea soup – is the late-night institution, fritz is the deli order, and every March the whole food city moves outdoors into the festival gardens. Eating out costs noticeably less than Sydney; the wine list is where SA quietly shows off.

The everyday, in one list

Serious shop: Central Market Thursday evening or Saturday morning; supermarkets for the rest.

Cheapest basket: ALDI; local loyalty: Drakes and Foodland; regional towns: the independent.

Specialist ingredients: west for Italian and Greek, north and north-east for Asian, African, Middle-Eastern and halal.

Bags in the car, bottles in a crate, fritz at least once.

Wine country, coast & ranges

South Australia Guide · Chapter 9 of 9

The recruiting pitch for South Australia is really a geography lesson: almost everything worth a weekend sits within an hour or two of the city. This chapter is what people actually do with that — and the festival month the whole year bends around.

BEYOND THE HOUR, AND WORTH IT

The wine regions are all inside two hours and covered below. This is the rest of the state, to scale against each other – the trips that need a weekend or a flight, and the reason people who move here keep exploring for years.

Kangaroo Island

Wildlife, wilderness
beaches and
remarkable food – a
ferry, or 35 minutes in
the air



Ferry or 35 min flight

The Limestone Coast

World Heritage fossil caves
and the crater lakes – one
of them impossibly blue
each summer



~4 hours

Ikara-Flinders Ranges

Wilpena Pound and 800
million years of geology in
the outback light – the
state's great camping
country



~5 hours

The Eyre Peninsula

Oyster sheds, tuna
towns, sea-lion swims
and Southern Ocean
cliffs – the serious
ocean



Short flight, or a road trip

Indicative driving times; the two flight options are why South Australians treat the island and the west coast as long weekends rather than annual leave. The Riverland and the Coorong sit between these, a couple of hours east.

The wine hours

Four of the world's best-known wine regions ring the capital. The Barossa and the Adelaide Hills are inside an hour; McLaren Vale is forty minutes down the coast, where the vines run almost to the sea; the Clare Valley sits within two, its old railway now the Riesling Trail for a day's cycling between cellar doors. The

practical effect: a long cellar-door lunch is a normal Saturday, not an anniversary. Vintage, in autumn, is the prettiest time to live here.

Coast and island

The city's own thirty kilometres of beach handle the everyday — jetty swims, esplanade runs, gulf sunsets that make the local news. Weekends stretch to the Fleurieu's surf and coves, and to Kangaroo Island — a ferry or a 35-minute flight — for wildlife, wilderness beaches and remarkable food. Further west, the Eyre Peninsula is the serious ocean: oyster sheds, tuna towns, sea-lion swims and Southern Ocean cliffs, a short flight or a proper road trip away.

Ranges and river

North of the vines the land climbs into the Flinders Ranges — Ikara-Flinders Ranges National Park and the vast natural amphitheatre of Wilpena Pound, some 800 million years of geology standing in the outback light. It is the state's great camping and walking country, five hours up the road and worth every one. East, the Murray winds through the Riverland: houseboats, river red gums and the birdlife of the Coorong's lagoons where the river meets the sea. South-east again, the Limestone Coast hides World Heritage fossil caves and the crater lakes — one famously, impossibly blue each summer.

The festival year

Mad March

The Fringe — the southern hemisphere's biggest arts festival — plus the Adelaide Festival, WOMADelaide and the motorsport, all at once. The city doubles in energy for a month.

Winter

Illuminate lights up the city in July; the Hills do log fires and galleries; the footy fills the oval — and the Showdown derby splits every workplace in two.

Spring & vintage

Tasting Australia in autumn, jacarandas and show season in spring, and harvest turning the valleys gold twice a year.

Ten weekends, to start

Barossa cellar doors and a bakery crawl through Tanunda and Angaston

McLaren Vale long lunch, then d'Arenberg's coast road home via Sellicks

The Riesling Trail by bike through the Clare Valley

Kangaroo Island — Remarkable Rocks, sea lions and the island's produce

Wilpena Pound and the Flinders Ranges under outback stars

Hahndorf and the Adelaide Hills lookouts, fog and all

A houseboat weekend on the Murray from the Riverland towns

The Coorong's lagoons and the mouth of the great river

Port Lincoln — oysters where they grow, and a swim with the sea lions

Mad March: one Fringe show, one Festival night, one WOMADelaide afternoon

Eyre Peninsula oysters, eaten close to where they grow

That's the guide

Nine chapters on South Australia. Everything national — Medicare, visas, registration, tax, super, schools — lives once in **Moving to Australia**. When you're ready to talk about real roles here, **we're easy to reach** — and there's no pipeline waiting on the other end of the call.